

Employee and Operations Policy Handbook

A synthetic enterprise policy corpus for retrieval-augmented generation testing

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VERSION	2.1
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POLICY OWNER	People Operations and Risk
CLASSIFICATION	Internal - Synthetic Test Data

Testing
note

This handbook is fictional and contains no real company, employee, customer, or confidential information. It is intentionally structured with policy IDs, dates, roles, thresholds, exceptions, and cross-references to support RAG evaluation.

Contents

Use the policy IDs as stable retrieval anchors. Each policy has a defined owner, effective date, review cadence, scope, requirements, exceptions, and escalation path.

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How to read this document

- Mandatory language uses must or required. Recommended practices use should.
- A policy exception is valid only when the named approver records the business reason, scope, expiry date, and compensating control.
- Questions about interpretation go first to the policy owner; suspected violations go to the reporting channel listed in Appendix A.
- Dates and thresholds are intentionally explicit to enable exact-match and semantic retrieval tests.

00 | Company Profile and Governance

XYZ Company is a fictional global software and services business with approximately 1,200 employees across North America, Europe, and Asia-Pacific. The company designs workflow automation tools for mid-market customers. This profile supplies context for the policies that follow.

Governance model

Role	Accountability
Board Risk Committee	Reviews material enterprise risks, policy exceptions over 90 days, and annual control attestations.
Chief Executive Officer	Approves company-wide policy framework and unresolved high-severity matters.
Chief Information Security Officer	Owns security controls, incident response, access reviews, and security awareness.
Chief Privacy Officer	Owns privacy notices, data subject requests, retention standards, and privacy incidents.
People Operations	Maintains employee acknowledgements, training records, and conduct investigations.

Policy lifecycle

Policies are reviewed at least annually and whenever there is a material change in law, technology, business model, or risk appetite. The policy owner proposes revisions, Legal and Risk review the draft, and the Chief Executive Officer or delegated executive approves publication. Published versions are stored in the controlled policy library. The previous version remains archived for seven years.

Default rule

When two internal documents conflict, the more specific policy controls for its stated scope. When a legal or regulatory requirement is stricter, the stricter requirement controls and Legal must be consulted.

Code of Conduct and Conflicts of Interest

POLICY ID	POL-001	OWNER	People Operations
EFFECTIVE	January 15, 2026	NEXT REVIEW	January 15, 2027

Purpose and scope

POL-001 establishes expected professional behavior for employees, contractors, interns, and officers acting for XYZ Company. It applies at company locations, customer sites, business travel, online workspaces, and company-sponsored events.

Core requirements

- Treat colleagues, customers, and partners with dignity. Harassment, discrimination, retaliation, threats, and deliberate intimidation are prohibited.
- Protect company property, records, credentials, and intellectual property. Use assets only for authorized business or approved limited personal purposes.
- Disclose an actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest to the manager and People Operations within 10 business days of becoming aware of it.
- Do not offer or accept a gift, meal, or entertainment valued above USD 150 per person without written approval from the business unit leader.
- Never use confidential company or customer information for personal trading, personal gain, or the benefit of a family member or close associate.

Conflict review examples

Scenario	Required action	Approver
Employee owns shares in a direct competitor	Disclose before participating in related procurement or product decisions.	People Operations and Legal
Supplier offers a USD 200 conference dinner	Decline or obtain written exception before accepting.	Business unit leader
Family member applies to XYZ	Disclose relationship; do not influence hiring or compensation decision.	Hiring manager and People Operations

Reporting and non-retaliation

Reports may be made to a manager, People Operations, Legal, or ethics@xyz.example. XYZ prohibits retaliation against a person who raises a good-faith concern or participates in an investigation. Breaches may result in corrective action up to termination and, where appropriate, referral to authorities.

Information Security and Access Control

POLICY ID	POL-002	OWNER	Information Security
EFFECTIVE	January 15, 2026	NEXT REVIEW	July 15, 2026

Purpose and scope

POL-002 protects XYZ systems, source code, customer environments, and company data from unauthorized access, alteration, disclosure, or loss. It applies to all workforce members and all devices or services used to perform XYZ work.

Access control standards

- Use a unique company identity. Shared accounts are prohibited except for documented service accounts owned by a named team.
- Multi-factor authentication is required for email, source control, production systems, finance systems, and any service handling Restricted data.
- Access must follow least privilege and be approved by the system owner. Managers must review direct-report access every 90 days.
- Departing worker access must be disabled within 4 hours of the confirmed separation time; involuntary separations require immediate disablement.
- Security patches rated critical must be applied within 14 calendar days, unless the CISO approves a compensating control and a dated remediation plan.

Password and device rules

Control	Standard
Passphrase	At least 14 characters; do not reuse a company passphrase on another service.
Screen lock	Automatic lock after 10 minutes of inactivity; use full-disk encryption on portable devices.
Removable media	Only company-encrypted media approved by Information Security may store Restricted data.
Public networks	Use the company VPN when accessing internal resources from an untrusted network.
Security events	Report suspected phishing, lost devices, or exposed credentials within 30 minutes to security@xyz.example.

Emergency exception

The on-call security lead may grant a temporary access exception during a service outage. The exception must be logged within 24 hours, expire within 72 hours, and include a post-event review.

Data Privacy, Classification, and Retention

POLICY ID	POL-003	OWNER	Privacy Office
EFFECTIVE	January 15, 2026	NEXT REVIEW	January 15, 2027

Purpose and scope

POL-003 defines how XYZ classifies, handles, shares, and disposes of information. It covers employee, applicant, customer, vendor, product, telemetry, and support data in any format.

Classification levels

Level	Definition	Minimum handling
Public	Approved for public release.	May be shared externally after content owner approval.
Internal	Routine business information not intended for public release.	Share with workforce members who need it for work; use company storage.
Confidential	Non-public business, customer, employee, or partner information.	Encrypt in transit and at rest; share only with approved recipients.
Restricted	Sensitive personal data, credentials, payment data, regulated records, or security secrets.	Need-to-know access, strong authentication, approved systems, and documented retention.

Retention rules

- Support tickets and customer communications: retain for 24 months after closure, unless a contract or legal hold requires longer.
- Employee personnel records: retain for 7 years after separation, subject to local law.
- Security logs: retain for 13 months; preserve relevant logs longer when Legal or Security issues a hold.
- Payment card data: do not store full card numbers. Use the approved payment processor token and retain transaction references for 7 years.
- Delete or anonymize data at the end of the retention period using an approved disposal method.

Privacy rights	Privacy requests, including access, correction, deletion, or objection requests, must be forwarded to privacy@xyz.example within 2 business days. Do not respond directly unless the Privacy Office provides approved language.
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Remote Work and Acceptable Technology Use

POLICY ID	POL-004	OWNER	People Operations and IT
EFFECTIVE	January 15, 2026	NEXT REVIEW	January 15, 2027

Purpose and scope

POL-004 supports flexible work while maintaining confidentiality, availability, and respectful collaboration. It applies to work performed outside an XYZ office, including home offices, coworking spaces, and temporary work locations.

Remote work requirements

- Maintain a private workspace for calls involving Confidential or Restricted information. Use headphones in shared locations.
- Do not leave company devices unattended in vehicles, cafes, airports, or other public places. Report loss within 30 minutes under POL-002.
- Use XYZ-managed devices for production work unless IT has approved a bring-your-own-device arrangement.
- Employees working internationally for more than 20 consecutive calendar days must obtain approval from People Operations, Tax, and their manager before travel.
- Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 in the employee's assigned time zone unless a team charter states otherwise.

Acceptable use

Allowed	Limited personal browsing, personal calls, and personal email when they do not interfere with work, consume excessive resources, or create security risk.
Prohibited	Illegal activity, harassment, cryptocurrency mining, unauthorized software, bypassing security controls, and storing Restricted data in personal cloud accounts.
Monitoring	XYZ may log security, network, and device events for safety, support, compliance, and incident response, subject to applicable law.
Ergonomics	Employees should report workstation hazards and may request an ergonomic assessment through People Operations.

Location exception

A manager may approve temporary work from another country for up to 20 consecutive calendar days when People Operations confirms payroll, immigration, tax, and data-transfer impacts are acceptable.

Travel, Meetings, and Expense Reimbursement

POLICY ID	POL-005	OWNER	Finance
EFFECTIVE	January 15, 2026	NEXT REVIEW	January 15, 2027

Purpose and scope

POL-005 defines reasonable, necessary, and documented business spending. It applies to employees, contractors, and anyone using an XYZ purchasing card or requesting reimbursement.

Approval thresholds

Spend type	Pre-approval	Documentation
Domestic travel under USD 1,000	Manager approval before booking.	Itinerary, business purpose, and itemized receipts.
International travel or travel over USD 1,000	Manager and Finance approval before booking.	Itinerary, business purpose, cost estimate, and itemized receipts.
Customer entertainment over USD 150 per person	Business unit leader approval before the event.	Attendees, customer purpose, date, location, and receipt.
Equipment over USD 500	Cost center owner approval before purchase.	Vendor quote, business justification, and asset tag after receipt.

Reimbursement rules

- Submit expenses in the expense system within 30 calendar days after the transaction or trip end date, whichever is later.
- Economy airfare is required for flights under 6 hours. Premium economy may be used for flights of 6 hours or more with manager approval.
- Alcohol is reimbursable only as part of a reasonable business meal and only where permitted by law and customer policy.
- Tips up to 20 percent are reimbursable for customary services. Personal upgrades, minibar charges, fines, and commuting are not reimbursable.

Late submission exception

Finance may accept an expense submitted up to 60 days late when the employee documents the reason and the cost center owner confirms the business purpose. Expenses older than 60 days require Controller approval.

Incident Response and Business Continuity

POLICY ID	POL-006	OWNER	Security and Resilience
EFFECTIVE	January 15, 2026	NEXT REVIEW	April 15, 2026

Purpose and scope

POL-006 provides a common process for identifying, containing, resolving, and learning from incidents that affect people, systems, customers, facilities, or company operations.

Severity and response targets

Severity	Example	Acknowledge	Update cadence
SEV-1 Critical	Widespread outage, active breach, or material safety threat.	15 minutes	Every 30 minutes
SEV-2 High	Major customer impact or suspected unauthorized access with limited scope.	30 minutes	Every 2 hours
SEV-3 Moderate	Localized service issue or policy breach with no confirmed material exposure.	4 business hours	Daily
SEV-4 Low	Question, minor defect, or event handled through normal support.	2 business days	As needed

Response lifecycle

- Detect and report: notify the service desk, Security Operations, or the emergency channel; preserve evidence and do not speculate publicly.
- Triage and contain: assign severity, incident commander, communications lead, and technical owners; isolate affected systems when safe.
- Eradicate and recover: remove the cause, restore from known-good backups, validate monitoring, and confirm customer impact.
- Close and learn: publish a blameless review within 10 business days for SEV-1 or SEV-2 incidents, including corrective owners and due dates.

Business continuity target	Critical customer-facing services target a recovery time objective of 4 hours and a recovery point objective of 1 hour. Exceptions must be documented in the service continuity register and reviewed by the Resilience Council.
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Generative AI and Third-Party Software

POLICY ID	POL-007	OWNER	Technology Governance
EFFECTIVE	January 15, 2026	NEXT REVIEW	January 15, 2027

Purpose and scope

POL-007 governs use of generative AI tools, code assistants, open-source components, and other third-party software in XYZ work. It applies whether a tool is paid for by XYZ, offered as a free service, or accessed through a personal account.

Approved use rules

- Use only tools listed in the approved technology catalog for Confidential or Restricted work. Public AI tools may be used for Public or sanitized Internal content only.
- Never enter customer data, credentials, production logs, source code marked Restricted, personal data, or unreleased financial information into an unapproved AI service.
- A human must review generated output for accuracy, security, bias, licensing, privacy, and customer impact before use or release.
- Do not represent generated content as human-authored when a customer, regulator, or contract requires disclosure of material automation.
- Record the tool name, material purpose, reviewer, and data category in the project record when AI materially influences a customer deliverable or production code.

Third-party software checks

Check	Required control	Owner
License	Confirm license compatibility before distribution; copyleft components require Legal review.	Engineering
Security	Scan dependencies and remediate critical vulnerabilities within 14 calendar days.	Application Security
Vendor data use	Review retention, training, subprocessors, and deletion terms before sending non-public data.	Privacy and Procurement
Model output	Test factual accuracy and prohibited-content risks for customer-facing features.	Product owner

Exception path

The Technology Governance Council may approve a time-limited exception after Security, Privacy, Legal, and the business owner sign off on the data flow, risk assessment, controls, and sunset date.

APP-A | Definitions, Contacts, and Policy Register

Key definitions

Term	Meaning
Business day	Monday through Friday, excluding the public holidays observed by the employee's employing entity.
Confidential data	Non-public information whose unauthorized disclosure could harm XYZ, a customer, an employee, or a partner.
Restricted data	The highest sensitivity category in POL-003, including credentials, payment data, sensitive personal data, and security secrets.
Material incident	An event that causes or may cause significant customer, legal, financial, safety, security, or reputational impact.
Policy exception	A documented, approved, time-limited deviation from a policy requirement with compensating controls.

Operational contacts

Need	Contact	Target response
Ethics or conduct concern	ethics@xyz.example	Acknowledge within 2 business days
Security event or phishing	security@xyz.example	30 minutes for suspected exposure
Privacy request	privacy@xyz.example	Forward within 2 business days
Expense question	finance@xyz.example	3 business days
Urgent service incident	Internal emergency channel	15 minutes for SEV-1

Policy register

Policy ID	Title	Owner	Review
POL-001	Code of Conduct and Conflicts of Interest	People Operations	Annual
POL-002	Information Security and Access Control	Information Security	Semiannual
POL-003	Data Privacy, Classification, and Retention	Privacy Office	Annual
POL-004	Remote Work and Acceptable Technology Use	People Operations and IT	Annual
POL-005	Travel, Meetings, and Expense Reimbursement	Finance	Annual
POL-006	Incident Response and Business Continuity	Security and Resilience	Quarterly
POL-007	Generative AI and Third-Party Software	Technology Governance	Annual

End of synthetic handbook. For RAG testing, consider queries about exact thresholds, response targets, retention periods, approval roles, exceptions, and cross-policy relationships.